Name: _____ Date: _____

THIRTEEN COLONIES

Three regions, many ways of life
New England, Middle, and Southern

Just Listen Learning • Episode 6 • Just listen, together.

1. Who or What Am I?

Write the word from the box that matches each clue.

proprietor Quaker holy experiment Pennsylvania Dutch
breadbasket plantation indigo assembly

1. An owner given land by the king to set up a colony
2. William Penn's faith; they would not fight in wars
3. What Penn called his colony
4. German settlers; back then, Dutch could mean German
5. Nickname for the wheat-growing middle colonies
6. A very large farm growing crops to sell abroad
7. A plant for blue dye, grown in South Carolina
8. Colony lawmakers, voted in by men who owned land

2. Poster Time!

Draw a Region

Pick one region. Draw something people did there, like fishing, wheat fields, or a busy port. Then finish the sentence.

My region: _____

3. Then and Now: True or False?

Read each sentence. Write T if it is true or F if it is false.

____ 1. The thirteen colonies were all started for the same reason.

____ 2. New Amsterdam became New York after the Dutch surrendered in 1664.

____ 3. A written copy of Penn's great elm-tree treaty survives today.

____ 4. Maryland began as a safe place for English Catholics.

____ 5. Slavery was legal only in the southern colonies.

____ 6. Georgia's first settlers were mostly people let out of debtors' prison.

4. Think About It!

Answer in complete sentences.

1. Pick two regions. How was life different in each one?

_____

_____

2. Name two things that tied the thirteen colonies together.

_____

_____

5. Timeline

Number the events 1 to 5, earliest first.

☐ Pennsylvania granted to Penn

☐ Maryland begins

☐ Savannah, Georgia founded

☐ Fundamental Orders written

☐ Dutch surrender New Amsterdam

Thirteen colonies, not copies of one town.

Answer Key: Thirteen Colonies

Just Listen Learning • Episode 6 • For parents and teachers

1. Who or What Am I?

1. proprietor
2. Quaker
3. holy experiment
4. Pennsylvania Dutch
5. breadbasket
6. plantation
7. indigo
8. assembly

2. Poster Time!

Drawings will vary. Look for a true detail from the story: New England (small family farms, fishing, timber, ships, a meetinghouse), Middle colonies (wheat fields, busy ports like Philadelphia and New York), or the South (long growing seasons, plantations, tobacco, rice, indigo).

3. Then and Now: True or False?

1. F (some were started by companies, some by people looking for a place to worship, and some were land gifts to proprietors)
2. T (the king gave the land to his brother, the Duke of York)
3. F (no written copy survives; the elm tree story is a tradition, and parts may be legend)
4. T (it began in 1634; its 1649 Toleration Act protected Christians of different churches)
5. F (slavery was legal in all thirteen colonies, but it was largest in the South)
6. F (that is mostly a legend; not one former prisoner for debt was among the first settlers)

4. Think About It!

1. New England: short summers, rocky soil, small family farms, fishing, timber, ships, towns close together around the meetinghouse. Middle colonies: good soil, so much wheat they were called the breadbasket; busy ports full of different languages and churches. South: long, warm growing seasons; plantations growing tobacco, rice, and indigo to sell abroad; planters depended on enslaved Africans.
2. Any two: the same king; the English language and English law; an assembly in each colony where landowning men voted for lawmakers; trade across the Atlantic that had to go through England; being used to solving their own problems far from London.

5. Timeline

1. Maryland begins (1634)
2. Fundamental Orders written (1639)
3. Dutch surrender New Amsterdam (1664)
4. Pennsylvania granted to Penn (1681)
5. Savannah, Georgia founded (1733)

Box numbers as printed, top to bottom: 4, 1, 5, 2, 3

All drawings on this worksheet are original line art. Facts come from the Just Listen episode "Thirteen Colonies".